home country,' Diego Aguirre explained, 'he knew he would die in Chile. They understood that the country they loved no longer existed.'13

At the same time, over in Berlin, half a dozen members of the tiny Communist Party of Germany held a small memorial service at the socialist cemetery in Friedrichsfelde, a few metres away from the well-manicured graves of Walter Ulbricht and Edith Baumann.14

Looking back, Roberto Yanez said his grandfather was sacrificed to the communist system, which he had helped to create. 'His own secret service kept files on him and his wife. He was the victim of his unwavering belief in his big brother, the Soviet Union.'15

The urn containing his ashes remained with Margot, who continued to live a peaceful life in Chile. She seldom gave statements to the press and only spoke a couple of times to sympathetic journalists. She defended the GDR, the Berlin Wall, and said that German unification was a mistake. On the 10th anniversary of the fall of the Wall in 1999, she slammed her front door in the face of reporters asking how she would spend the day. In her only notable TV interview in 2012, she called the fall of the communist regime a 'counter-revolution', and lamented the demise of the GDR: 'It is a tragedy that this country no longer exists.' She also took the opportunity to complain about her monthly pension of almost €2000, a comfortable income in Chile. But by this point, Margot was already battling breast cancer, which returned aggressively in January 2016 and spread up her spine. She rented the La Reina apartment to pay for round-the-clock care from Chilean nurses who administered morphine to relieve the pain: 'I get injected with opium every four hours,' she told one friend. Her death in May 2016, was announced by the Communist Party of Chile:

Hundreds of exiled Chilean communists remember and deeply appreciate the solidarity and friendship in which Margot Honecker took an active part – solidarity that reached the Chilean people in the difficult moments of the dictatorship that struck our country from September 1973.